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The Our Father

The prayer Jesus taught us — Matthew 6:9–13

Our Father,
who art in heaven,
hallowed be Thy name.

We begin by remembering who God is — our loving Father in heaven. Hallowed means holy. We honor His name above all others.

Thy kingdom come,
Thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.

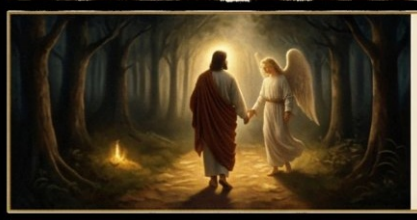
We ask God to bring His love and peace to our world. We trust that His plan is better than ours — even when we do not understand it.

Give us this day
our daily bread.

We ask God for everything we need — food, health, love. Daily bread also means the Eucharist — the bread of life Jesus gives us at every Mass.

And forgive us our
trespasses, as we forgive
those who trespass against us.

We ask God to forgive our sins — and we promise to forgive others too. This is the hardest line in the prayer. And the most important.



And lead us not
into temptation.

We ask God to help us make good choices. *Temptation* means wanting to do someting. We are admitting we need His help — and that is a sign of wisdom.

But deliver us from evil.

We ask God to protect us from harm — physical and spiritual. We cannot fight evil alone. But with God beside us, we never have to.

For Thine is the kingdom,
and the power, and the glory,
forever and ever. Amen.

We end by giving everything back to God. The kingdom is His. The power is His. The glory is His. And *Amen* means: yes, I believe every word of this.

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Jesus taught this prayer to His disciples when they asked:
Lord, teach us to pray. He is teaching you too.

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"Lord, teach us to pray." — Luke 11:1